



KOGI

GUARDIANS OF OUR WORLD

NATIVES OF THE HIGH SIERRA NEVADA de Santa Marta mountains in northern Colombia, the Kogi are one of the few indigenous Amerindian groups who were not conquered by the Spanish. Descended from the sophisticated Tairona civilization that flourished



MINIATURE WORLD

The 8,000 sq miles (17,000 sq kilometers) of the Sierra Nevada are home to an astonishing variety of ecosystems, from turquoise waters and coral reefs to deserts, plains, rain forests, and glaciers.

ON THE MOVE

Kogi families do not stay in one place, but move between different levels, according to the natural rhythm of the seasons and the fertility of the land. Horses provide the main means of transportation in this steep landscape, which is crisscrossed with narrow paths instead of roads.

The place of creation

The land of the Kogi is set apart from the rest of the continent, in a mountain range near the Caribbean coast. These enlightened people have spent centuries exploring the realms of mind, body, and spirit. They believe that if the rest of humanity (what they call the “younger brother”) does anything to harm their sacred homeland, then the whole world will be doomed as well.

NATURE'S CARERS

The Kogi people are convinced that their crops will grow less successfully if the plants are cultivated by men, since women have a stronger and more direct link with fertility and growth.

Families move around from season to season so they are able to get the best from all the land they farm without exhausting its goodness.



SHELL SEEKER

An elder gathers shells on the beach for use in one of the main Kogi rituals: the chewing of coca leaves by adult males. Burned shells produce fine white lime powder. When mixed with leaves and saliva in the mouth, it helps the chemical stimulant in the plant to be absorbed.

